



SOUTH CURL CURL NIPPERS INFORMATION BOOKLET



2026/27

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WELCOME TO SOUTH CURL CURL NIPPERS

This handbook sets out information about the Nippers program at South Curlly. It is useful to both new parents that are considering signing their kids up and renewing nippers.

After over 106 years in active service, South Curl Curl Surf Lifesaving Club continues to build on its strengths – on the sand, in the water, and in our community! Our Nippers program has always been an integral part of our club, where we focus on having fun while learning the important skills of beach safety and a lifelong passion and respect for the ocean. We hope that through the supportive environment of Nippers, we are developing our future surf life savers, that will hopefully, one day, take over the responsibility of patrolling our amazing South Curl Curl beach.

We are an inclusive Surf Club and pride ourselves on making Nippers accessible to all and providing opportunities for all Nippers, regardless of their abilities, to participate and enjoy learning in the beach environment. We encourage our Nippers to “have a go” during our Sunday sessions, training afternoons and carnivals (if we have enough volunteer officials and eager parents for those Nippers that would like to compete). With our amazing Rippers Nipper program, we can also provide a side-by-side disability program for children, youth and adults with additional needs. This program provides a supportive and individually adjusted program to allow inclusion for all participants who want to be part of the Nippers fun.

As we embark on this new season, we look forward to seeing our Nippers grow, learn, and have fun. We hope you make lasting memories and friendships while developing essential lifesaving skills. Welcome to the South Curl Curl Surf Life Saving Club family, and we look forward to a fantastic Nippers season!

SUNDAY ACTIVITIES

When and Where

To give the younger age groups a chance to use the beach & pool without being inundated by the older Nippers, we have separate starting times for the younger and older age groups:

- **8.45am - 9.45am** **Under 6, 7 and 8 and SRC (U14)**
- **10.00am - 11.00am** **Under 9 – Under 13 and Rippers**

The younger age groups can take a bit longer than the allocated hour depending on numbers and helpers available.

Sign-In and Sign-Out:

All Nippers must be signed in at the start of each session and sign out with their Age Manager before leaving their age group. If you need to take your child out of a session early or they are unwell and cannot finish the session, ensure the Nipper is signed off by the Age Manager or assistant before leaving the beach. It is the parents' responsibility to ensure their child has signed in and out, regardless of the age group.

What to Wear

For safety reasons ALL children MUST wear the following uniform during all Sunday Nippers activities:

- **Nipper age colour cap**
- **Yellow SCC rash-vest**

Different cap colours are assigned for each age group, as shown below. If your child is continuing from last year, they will be able to reuse their cap.

Nippers caps are to be removed once Nippers activities have finished.

Age Group Cap Colours for 2026-27

U6	Yellow
U7	White
U8	Red
U9	Pink
U10	Lime Green
U11	Mauve
U12	Aqua
U13	Royal Blue
U14 "The SRCs"	South Curly Cap
Rippers	South Curly Cap

Please write your child's first name in large letters using a thick waterproof black marker on both sides of their cap. This will assist the Age Managers and our Water Safety team identify the Nippers easily and is also helpful with lost property.

Uniforms can be purchased online through the SCC Online Shop www.southcurlcurlslsc.com.au and pick-up can be arranged through the South Curl Curl uniform shop, which will be open on our Nippers Open Day as well as on most Sundays during the season.

Sun Safety

To ensure all Nippers are well protected from the sun, please apply sunscreen 30 minutes before arriving at the beach and ensure they are wearing a rash vest when appropriate. Bring a drink bottle for hydration during warmer weather and to wash out any sand that may get into their eyes.

Wetsuits

Nippers is about having fun, and for many children, enjoying the sand and water activities is challenging when they become cold (especially at the beginning of the season when ocean temperatures are still low). A well fitted wetsuit or wetsuit top is recommended while temperatures are still mild, to ensure Nippers are able to enjoy their Sunday morning activities. For safety reasons, the yellow SCC rash vest must still be worn over the top of the wetsuit.

PLEASE NOTE: A PARENT OR GUARDIAN IS REQUIRED TO BE ON THE BEACH AT ALL TIMES DURING NIPPERS (NIPPERS IS NOT A CHILD-MINDING PROGRAM).

SOUTH CURLY WELCOMES PARENT PARTICIPATION – WE ENCOURAGE PARENTS TO BECOME AGE MANAGERS / AGE ASSISTANTS OR BRONZE-PROFICIENT WATER SAFETY TO BE INVOLVED “ON THE BEACH”.

AGE GROUP CALCULATION

The age group for your child is calculated from the age they are on or prior to 30 Sept. For example, if your child is 11 on the 30th September they will be in the Under 12 age group for the season.

THE AGE OF CHILD AT 30 th SEPT	NIPPERS AGE CATEGORY
5	Under 6
6	Under 7
7	Under 8
8	Under 9
9	Under 10
10	Under 11
11	Under 12
12	Under 13
13	Under 14

We understand that the kids like to participate with their friends and we will accommodate where possible, however, there is some restriction to the flexibility of moving children between their designated age groups. Please contact the Junior Activity Chair at nippers@southcurlcurlslsc.com.au if you wish to discuss the possibility for your child to participate outside of their designated age group.

THE RIPPERS NIPPER PROGRAM

South Curl Curl offers a side-by-side disability Nippers program for children, youth and adults with additional needs. Following the SLS Nipper program, the program has been developed to allow inclusion for all participants aged 6 to 40+ **and** can be modified for each individual.

The program aims to teach the following skills:

- surf awareness and
- beach safety

The sessions will also include fun activities such as:

- beach races,
- flags,
- wade and swim races.
- obstacle races

As members of this group become more confident in the water, they learn skills to be able to use nipper surfboards and catch a wave or two to shore.

The Rippers group are supported by volunteers from South Curl Curl Surf Lifesaving Club, however family members are actively encouraged to participate with their child so everyone can share in the excitement as each member masters new skills throughout the season.

South Curl Curl encourage members of 'Rippers' to join in their age mainstream group if they wish and are welcome to participate in both groups. Our main focus is to make sure members are actively learning whilst having fun!

Email rippers@southcurlcurlslsc.com.au if you have any questions about or would like to help out with our Ripper program

VOLUNTEERS RUN NIPPERS

The Club operates entirely on volunteer help. There are many jobs, and for many you don't need surf lifesaving experience. It is our experience that ***the more you get involved, the more your child will enjoy Nippers.***

Official roles that volunteers can help with include:

- Lead Age Managers
- Age Managers
- Age Group Assistants
- Water Safety (Bronze Medallion required)
- Carnival Entry Assistance
- Carnival Officials

Some of the most helpful roles include:

- Marking the Nippers on/off the roles at the start/finish of Nippers sessions
- Retrieving and managing the ice blocks for the end of the session (an extremely vital role!!)
- Setting up/packing down equipment used for the session (age signs, hoops, balls, boards, etc) and making sure they are returned neatly to the Nippers Room.

Your assistance throughout the season will make a huge difference to the success of our Nippers program. Please reach out to our wonderful Age Managers on the beach or email nippers@southcurlcurlslsc.com.au if you can help us in any way.

AGE MANAGERS

If you would like to officially help our current Age Managers coordinate Sunday morning sessions, please let us know—we always need more people. Previous experience and/or Bronze Medallion is advantage, but not essential. Much of the help needed is organising and guiding our Nippers through their activities. There are pre-written resources to follow and experienced Age Managers on the sand that will provide support and mentorship as you learn the ropes. We welcome on board anyone interested in helping, in any capacity – many hands make light work.

Anyone officially assisting with the Nippers sessions on the beach and in the water should be registered as an associate member of the Club to ensure you are covered by the appropriate insurance.

WATER SAFETY

Bronze Medallion

Parents and carers are not permitted to join their children in the swim or board activities unless they are current proficient bronze holders and signed in as water safety volunteers. Parents are encouraged to obtain their Bronze Medallion to fulfill this requirement.

At the beginning and during the season training is arranged for people interested in obtaining their Bronze Medallion. The Bronze Medallion course can be one of the most rewarding courses you can attempt – often a great personal achievement. Once qualified it helps us meet our water safety requirements as SLSC mandates that nippers water safety must be performed by proficient Bronze Medallion holders. Having achieved your Bronze Medallion, you can also join the South Curl Beach Patrols; another great way to participate in the Club, meet new friends and give back our community.

Nipper Safety Assistants (NSA)

A new Nipper Safety Assistant (NSA) Award has been created by SLSC to assist clubs with additional resources for water safety during Nippers. NSAs can support Water Safety Personnel during Nipper activities when:

- Conditions are confirmed as low risk eg. in the pool
- The age group is U8 or below.
- Activities are shallow water only.
- NSAs do not make up more than 50% of the water safety team for the Nipper activity.

Volunteers wishing to become an NSA will need to complete the following skill evaluation:

- Swim 50m
- 2 min treading water
- Knowledge of signals
- Rescue tube orientation and practice

CHILD PROTECTION

Age Managers and Water Safety (where outside your own child's age group for more than 5 sessions) also need to apply and show proof of approval for the "Working With Children Check" (WWC) for child protection. Please complete the registration process at:

<https://www.service.nsw.gov.au/transaction/apply-for-a-working-with-children-check> and once you received your approval email (from 1 week, but up to 4 weeks), please email your approval WWC number and details to: mail@southcurlcurlslsc.com.au

PRELIMINARY SKILLS EVALUATION

Nippers is not a learn-to-swim program and does not teach children to swim. While being a good swimmer is not required, we highly recommend enrolling your children in learn-to-swim programs or squad training.

Before children can participate in any water activity, they must complete the Preliminary Skills Evaluation (see table below). These requirements are tailored to match the abilities and developmental stages of the children, ensuring they are comfortable and capable in the water.

These evaluations will be carried out in the South Curl Curl rockpool during the first few weeks of the Nippers season. Prior to any competition Nippers must complete the next phase of this evaluation i.e. Competition Skills Evaluation. Details of the Junior Activities Competition Skills Evaluation requirements can be found on the SLSC website.

Nippers who cannot meet the skills evaluation for their age group, will need to be supervised 1:1 by a Water Safety volunteer during any water-based activities. In this situation, their participation may be limited by the availability of adequate Water Safety volunteers at the time.

In instances where evaluations cannot be completed during the Nippers sessions, a qualified and accredited swim coach can complete the evaluation. In this instance, please contact the Junior Activities Chair to arrange a copy of the required template with the required information for the evaluation.

AGE GROUP	PRELIMINARY EVALUATION	COMPETITION EVALUATION	AGE GROUP
Under 6	From a standing position in waist-deep water, perform a front glide and recover to a secure position. Perform a back or front float holding a buoyant aid and recover to a secure position.		Surf Play 1
Under 7	From a standing position in waist-deep water, perform a front glide, kick for 3m and recover to a secure position. Perform a back or front float for a few seconds and recover to a secure position.		Surf Play 2
Under 8	25m swim (any recognised stroke) 1-minute survival float	Nil (no water competition, except for wade which takes place in waist-deep water)	Surf Aware 1
Under 9	25m swim (any recognised stroke) 1 minute survival float	Minimum 150m open water swim (any recognised stroke)	Surf Aware 2
Under 10	25m swim (any recognised stroke) 1.5 minute survival float	Minimum 150m open water swim (any recognised stroke)	Surf Safe 1
Under 11	50m swim (any recognised stroke) 2 minute survival float	Minimum 200m open water swim (any recognised stroke)	Surf Safe 2
Under 12	100m swim (any recognised stroke) 2 minute survival float	Minimum 200m open water swim (any recognised stroke)	Surf Smart 1
Under 13	150m swim (any recognised stroke) 3 minute survival float	Minimum 200m open water swim (any recognised stroke)	Surf Smart 2
Under 14	200m swim (any recognised stroke, in less than 5 minutes) 3 minute survival float	Minimum 200m open water swim (any recognised stroke)	Surf Rescue Certificate (SRC)

NIPPERS SURF EDUCATION AWARD

The Nippers Surf Education Awards are designed to recognise the knowledge and skills that children acquire throughout the Nippers program. These awards are an integral part of the Junior Development Program and are tailored to the specific age groups of the participants. Surf education is a continuous process reinforced throughout each Nippers session. To be eligible for the SLSNSW award, Nippers must achieve 70% attendance across the season.

CARNIVALS

Carnivals are a great way for kids to test the skills they have developed at nippers. We encourage all kids to go along and have a go. It's about building up confidence and enjoying the events. Sydney Northern Beaches Branch conducts carnivals during the season for age groups U8 upwards for Beach, and U9 upwards for Water.

The main limiting factor to entering nippers in carnivals is that volunteer officials must also be provided by the Club. **For the 2026/27 season we will need volunteer carnival officials, a competition manager and water safety** to support any nippers who wish to participate in these events.

The Carnival Official Course has no pre-requisites and is open to anyone. Furthermore, you can pick the area in which you wish to officiate on the day, and you have the best beach-side view of what's going on.

REGISTRATION

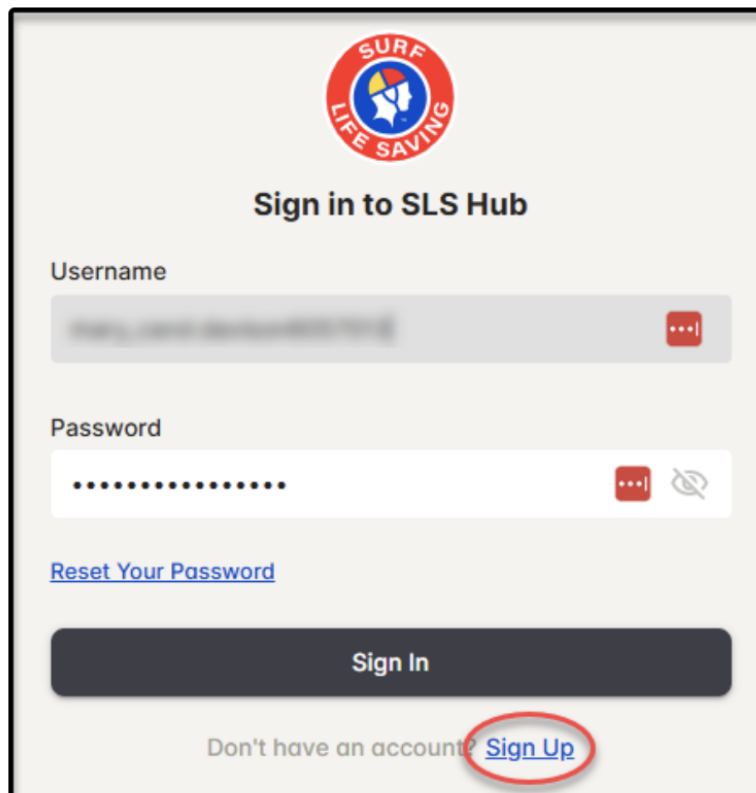
Both new memberships and renewals should be completed online through the [SLS Hub](#) . For detailed instructions on how to join South Curl Curl SLSC or renew your membership , please refer to the [SLS Hub User Guide](#)

For assistance with your registration, please come down the Nippers Open Day (see Calendar) where members of the Nippers team will be able to guide you through the process.

For any additional enquiries regarding registration or club membership please email mail@southcurlcurlslsc.com.au

SLSA requires all nippers to be current financial members, non-financial members will therefore not be able to participate until their membership is renewed and paid online.

Online accounts need to be created for each club member (as each individual account moves with the member throughout their surf lifesaving membership). Memberships can then be linked together to make a family payment rather than separate payments for each member.

A screenshot of the SLS Hub login and registration interface. At the top is the "SURF LIFE SAVING" logo. Below it is the heading "Sign in to SLS Hub". There are two input fields: "Username" and "Password". The "Username" field has a red "Show/Hide" icon. The "Password" field has a red "Show/Hide" icon and a "Show/Hide" icon. Below the "Password" field is a link "Reset Your Password". At the bottom is a large "Sign In" button. Below the "Sign In" button is the text "Don't have an account?" followed by a link "Sign Up" which is circled in red.

2026/27 FEES FOR SOUTH CURL CURL SLSC:

Price List

Membership Fees	Other Fees
Active (15-18 yrs) - Renewing Active Junior Patrolling (15-18 yrs)	\$50.00
Active (15-18 yrs) - New Active 15-18 yrs Patrolling member 15-18 <i>Includes bronze training course</i>	\$300.00
Active (15-18 yrs) - SCC SRC to Bronze <i>Existing SCC member SRC doing BM (includes membership fee)</i>	\$100.00
Cadet Member (13-15 years) - Renewing Cadet SRC Grp (13-15 yrs) <i>See Active 15-18 if doing bronze trg</i>	\$100.00
Cadet Member (13-15 years) - New Cadet SRC Grp (13-15 yrs) <i>May include SRC training but not bronze training</i>	\$100.00
Active (18yrs and over) - Renewing Active Patrolling Member 18+ yrs	\$90.00
Active (18yrs and over) - New Active Patrolling Senior Member <i>Does not include any training or course fees</i>	\$90.00
Associate - Renewing Parent/Associate Membership <i>Does not include any training or gym access</i>	\$50.00
Associate - New Parent/Associate Membership <i>Does not include any training or gym access</i>	\$50.00
Junior Activity Member (5-13 years) - Renewing Junior/Nippers	\$100.00
Junior Activity Member (5-13 years) - New junior/nippers member	\$100.00
Life Member - Renewing Life Member	\$0.00
Past Active - Renewing past active	\$90.00
Other - Family cap <i>Assumes 2 adults and their children under 18 or full-time students, not including training courses</i>	\$275.00
Long Service - Renewing Over 60 yrs with 25 years service	\$30.00
Long Service - Renewing Under 60 yrs with 25 years service	\$90.00
Reserve Active - Renewing Over 60 with 25 years service	\$30.00
Reserve Active - Renewing Under 60 with 25 years service	\$90.00
Probationary - New Senior Member Bronze Medallion Course <i>Includes bronze training course & membership</i>	\$400.00
Award Member - Renewing Senior Award Member	\$90.00
Inclusive/Adaptive Program Participant - SCC Rippers	\$100.00

CODE OF CONDUCT FOR NSW NIPPERS SURF LIFE SAVING

The Code of Conduct for NSW Nippers Surf Life Saving outlines the expected behaviour of all participants, including Nippers, parents, carers and volunteers. This code ensures a safe, respectful, and enjoyable environment for everyone involved in the program. The key points include:

- **Respect and Fair Play:** All participants should show respect for others, including fellow Nippers, coaches, officials, and spectators. Fair play and sportsmanship are essential values to uphold.
- **Safety First:** Safety is the top priority. Participants must follow all safety guidelines and instructions provided by the Age Managers, Parent Helpers and Water Safety. This includes always wearing the appropriate uniform and safety gear.
- **Positive Attitude:** Nippers should maintain a positive attitude and encourage their peers. Bullying, harassment, or any form of negative behaviour will not be tolerated.
- **Participation and Effort:** Nippers are encouraged to participate fully in all activities and give their best effort. The focus is on personal development and enjoyment rather than winning.
- **Parental Support:** Parents and guardians should support their children in a positive manner. They should respect the decisions of coaches and officials and refrain from any negative or disruptive behaviour.
- **Volunteer Commitment:** Volunteers play a crucial role in the success of the Nippers program. They should fulfill their responsibilities with dedication and integrity, setting a positive example for the children.

By adhering to this Code of Conduct, we can ensure a positive and supportive environment for all participants in the South Curl Curl Nippers Program. For further information please refer to:

[Member Protection \(Code of Conduct Extracted\) - Surf Life Saving NSW.](#)

MEMBER PROTECTION AND COMPLAINTS

If any member believes there has been a breach of the code of conduct or wishes to make a complaint, they are encouraged to contact the Complaints Manager directly at complaints@southcurlcurlslsc.com.au. It is essential for the Surf Club to protect all members from discrimination, harassment, abuse, and other inappropriate behaviour. Prioritising member protection ensures a safe and positive environment where everyone can fully participate in club activities.

NIPPERS CALENDAR OF EVENTS 2026/2027

SEPTEMBER 2026

Sunday 13th NIPPERS INFORMATION DAY, 9 – 10am
Sunday 13th AGE MANAGERS MEETING, 10.30 – 12noon
Friday, 25th PROFICIENCY SWIM, IN2SWIM 6.30 – 8pm

OCTOBER 2026

Sunday 4th PROFICIENCY SWIM, IN2SWIM 12.30pm – 2pm
Sunday 18th First day of Nippers - Registration and Preliminary Evaluations
Sunday 25th Normal Nippers

NOVEMBER 2026

Sunday 1st Normal Nippers
Sunday 8th Normal Nippers
Sunday 15th Normal Nippers
Sunday 22nd Normal Nippers
Sunday 29th Normal Nippers

DECEMBER 2026

Sunday 6th Normal Nippers
Sunday 13th Christmas Nippers – All ages groups combined – 9.30am start
Sunday 20th NO Nippers
Sunday 27th NO Nippers

JANUARY 2027

Sunday 3rd NO Nippers
Sunday 10th NO Nippers
Sunday 17th Normal Nippers
Wed - Fri Nippers Board Camp (U9 – U13) – Dates to be confirmed
Sunday 24th Normal Nippers
Sunday 31st Normal Nippers

FEBRUARY 2027

Sunday 7th Normal Nippers
Sunday 14th Normal Nippers
Sunday 21st Normal Nippers
Sunday 28th Normal Nippers

MARCH 2027

Sunday 7th Normal Nippers
Sunday 14th Normal Nippers
Sunday 21st FINAL NIPPERS & PRESENTATION - All ages groups combined – 9.30am start

* Information valid as of August 2026 - subject to change

JOIN THE SOUTH CURL CURL NIPPERS WHATSAPP COMMUNITY

Stay connected and up to date with all Nippers activities and events by joining our WhatsApp community. This will ensure you receive the latest information, reminders, and any important announcements directly to your phone. We encourage all members to use the QR code or link join so you don't miss out on upcoming programs and opportunities.



https://chat.whatsapp.com/DpwkF9zUpLFBeyVW9eGdeV?mode=ems_copy_h_t

SURFARI – NIPPERS END-OF-SEASON CAMPING TRIP

Surfari is the South Curl Curl Nippers' annual end-of-season camp held at Racecourse Beach Tourist Park, Bawley Point NSW. It's a fun-filled, family-friendly tradition where members enjoy four days of activities including surfing, swimming, fishing, bike riding, games, a beach carnival, a talent show, and evening meals together.

DATES: **April 2027** (to be advised)

LOCATION: [Racecourse Beach Tourist Park](#), 381 Murramarang Road, Bawley Point NSW 2539

ACCOMMODATION: Camping is available (book early and mention "South Curly" for a discount). Cabins, villas, and bunkhouses may also be available, with priority for Age Managers and volunteers.

COSTS: Approximately \$30–\$35 per adult per day (excluding accommodation). Covers catering, equipment, BBQs, and transport.

Meals included:

- Bacon & egg BBQ brunch
- Kids' fruit & milkshakes
- Dinner each evening

Keep updated with the latest Surfari News:

Join the Surfari 2027 Facebook group, Instagram page, or WhatsApp group.

It's a great way to celebrate the season, make friends, and create lasting memories!



South Curly Surfari 2027